



SSETI CONSTITUTION



THE SOUTH SUDAN EDUCATIONAL TECHNOLOGY INITIATIVE (SSETI)

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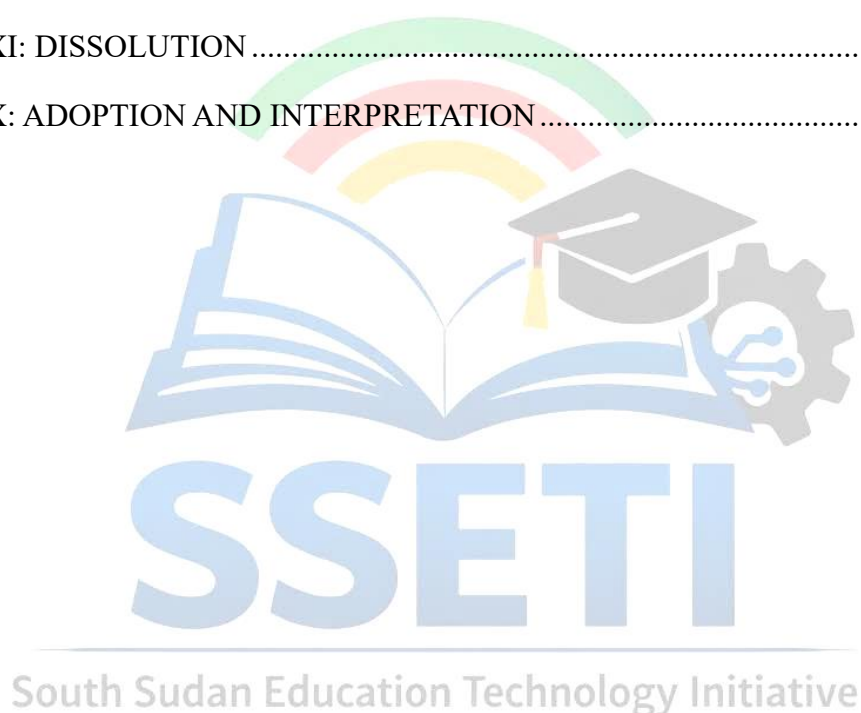
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PREAMBLE

We, the founders and members of the South Sudan Educational Technology Initiative (SSETI), recognizing the critical need for educational transformation in South Sudan through technological innovation, and acknowledging the power of digital literacy to empower future generations, hereby establish this constitution. We are committed to bridging the digital divide, fostering innovation, and creating sustainable educational solutions that will propel South Sudan toward a knowledge-based economy and a prosperous future for all its citizens.



Abstract

This document constitutes the official Constitution of the South Sudan Educational Technology Initiative (SSETI), a non-profit, non-governmental organization established to drive educational transformation in the Republic of South Sudan through technological innovation. Adopted to provide a formal governance and operational framework, the constitution outlines SSETI's core identity, strategic direction, and structural blueprint.

SSETI operates under the motto "Digital Literacy for National Prosperity" and is founded on the vision of a South Sudan where every learner and educator has equitable access to quality education and essential digital tools. Its mission is to advance educational excellence by integrating appropriate technology, building sustainable digital capacity, developing localized content, and empowering youth.

The constitution establishes SSETI's primary objectives, which include deploying digital learning infrastructure, training educators, developing open educational resources (OER), supporting youth innovation hubs, and advocating for supportive national policies. Key five-year strategic goals are set to ensure measurable impact.

Governance is vested in a General Assembly of members as the supreme body, which elects a Board of Directors responsible for strategic oversight. Day-to-day operations are managed by an Executive Director leading a professional Secretariat. The document defines membership categories, rights, and responsibilities to foster inclusive participation.

Robust provisions for financial management, audit and transparency, data governance, and ethical operation are enshrined to ensure accountability and sustainability. The constitution also details the processes for its own amendment and the principled procedure for organizational dissolution.

By formalizing this structure, SSETI commits to acting with integrity, collaboration, and a focus on local ownership to bridge the digital divide and contribute to a knowledge-based economy for South Sudan.

Background

South Sudan, the world's youngest nation, stands at a pivotal crossroads, rich with promise yet challenged by a profound educational and digital divide. With over 70% of its population under 30, this immense demographic dividend remains untapped, locked away by overcrowded classrooms, scarce resources, and a critical lack of connectivity, where mobile broadband penetration languishes below 25% (World Bank, 2023). The South Sudan Educational Technology Initiative (SSETI) was founded as a direct, strategic response to this national imperative, built on the conviction that the purposeful integration of educational technology is the essential accelerant to transform latent potential into a dynamic engine for innovation, peace, and a knowledge-based future.

SSETI's mission is therefore defined by a philosophy of appropriate and sustainable innovation, designing context-specific solutions for South Sudan's unique realities. Informed by landscape analyses that highlight the success of low-bandwidth, resilient EdTech models in fragile contexts (Powell & Mangan, 2022), we bypass infrastructural constraints by pioneering offline digital libraries, solar-powered learning labs, and mobile-first platforms. This ensures our interventions are practical, scalable, and meet the acute needs of underserved communities. This grounded approach is coupled with an unwavering commitment to local ownership, investing deeply in certifying South Sudanese educators and curating localized digital content aligned with the national curriculum (MoGEI), ensuring solutions are developed by and for South Sudanese.

Ultimately, SSETI operates at the critical intersection of demography and national development, directly supporting the goals outlined in South Sudan's National Digital Transformation Strategy (2022). By equipping the youth majority with relevant digital skills and creative tools, the initiative mitigates the risks of disillusionment while activating a generation of problem-solvers and creators. Through strategic partnerships and a steadfast commitment to equity and excellence, SSETI is not merely delivering technology—it is systematically building the foundational digital literacy required for South Sudan to achieve enduring stability and self-reliant prosperity.

ARTICLE I: ORGANIZATION IDENTITY AND LEGAL STATUS

Section 1.1: Official Name

The official name of the organization shall be the **South Sudan Educational Technology Initiative**, hereafter referred to as **SSETI** or the Initiative.

Section 1.2: Legal Status

SSETI shall be registered as a non-profit, non-governmental, non-political organization under the relevant laws of the Republic of South Sudan, including but not limited to the Non-Governmental Organizations Act and any subsequent legislation.

Section 1.3: Registered Office

The registered headquarters of SSETI shall be in **Juba, Central Equatoria, South Sudan**. The Board of Directors may establish additional operational offices in any state or administrative area of South Sudan as required to fulfill the Initiative's mission.

Section 1.4: Motto

Digital Literacy for National Prosperity.

Section 1.5: Official Logo and Brand

The organization shall adopt an official logo as described in Appendix A. All official correspondence, materials, and digital presence must reflect the approved branding guidelines.

ARTICLE II: VISION, MISSION, AND CORE VALUES

Section 2.1: Vision

A South Sudan where every learner, educator, and community has equitable access to quality education and the digital tools necessary to thrive in the 21st century.

Section 2.2: Mission

To advance educational excellence and innovation in South Sudan by integrating appropriate technology into learning ecosystems, building sustainable digital capacity, developing localized content, and empowering youth as creators and problem-solvers.

Section 2.3: Core Values

1. **Equity & Inclusion.** Ensuring access for all, regardless of gender, geographic location, socio-economic status, or ability.
2. **Innovation & Creativity.** Fostering a culture of problem-solving with context-appropriate, sustainable technological solutions.
3. **Integrity & Transparency.** Operating with the highest ethical standards, accountability, and open stewardship of all resources.
4. **Collaboration & Partnership.** Working with communities, government, academia, the private sector, and international partners for maximum impact.
5. **Excellence & Quality.** Committing to evidence-based practices, measurable outcomes, and continuous improvement in all programs.
6. **Sustainability & Local Ownership.** Building systems and skills that are maintained and advanced by South Sudanese for the long term.

ARTICLE III: OBJECTIVES AND STRATEGIC GOALS

Section 3.1: Primary Objectives

The Initiative shall work to achieve the following primary objectives:

1. To deploy and maintain digital learning infrastructure (hardware, software, connectivity) in underserved schools and community centers.
2. To build the capacity of educators through certified training programs in digital pedagogy and educational technology integration.
3. To develop, curate, and promote open educational resources (OER) and digital content relevant to the South Sudanese curriculum and context.
4. To establish and support innovation hubs, coding clubs, and maker-spaces for youth to develop digital creativity and entrepreneurial skills.
5. To advocate for and inform national policies that support the integration of technology in education.
6. To conduct and disseminate research on the effectiveness of educational technology interventions in South Sudan.

Section 3.2: Strategic Goals (6-Year Horizon)

1. Train 5,000 teachers in digital literacy and EdTech integration.
2. Establish 50 fully functional digital learning labs across all 10 states.
3. Develop a national online repository of localized digital learning materials.
4. Facilitate the launch of 100 youth-led tech innovation projects.
5. Achieve financial sustainability through a diversified funding model.

ARTICLE IV: MEMBERSHIP

Section 4.1: Membership Categories

1. **Founding Members:** The initial signatories of this constitution.
2. **General Members:** Individuals who support SSETI's mission, apply for membership, and are approved by the Membership Committee. They must pay an annual membership fee as determined by the Board.
3. **Institutional Members:** Educational institutions, corporations, or NGOs that partner formally with SSETI.
4. **Honorary Members:** Individuals conferred membership in recognition of exceptional service to SSETI's mission (non-voting).

Section 4.2: Rights of Members; General Members have the right to.

- a) Attend, speak, and vote at the Annual General Assembly (AGA).
- b) Stand for election to the Board of Directors (subject to qualifications).
- c) Access member-only resources and updates.
- d) Participate in SSETI committees and activities.

Section 4.3: Responsibilities of Members

- Uphold the constitution and core values of SSETI.
- Pay annual dues promptly (where applicable).
- Actively promote the mission and objectives of the Initiative.

- Participate in organizational activities and governance where possible.

Section 4.4: Termination of Membership

Membership may be terminated by:

1. Written resignation submitted to the Secretary.
2. Non-payment of membership fees for two consecutive years.
3. A two-thirds vote of the Board of Directors for conduct deemed prejudicial to the name, interests, or objectives of SSETI, following a fair hearing.
4. Violation of the Organization's Constitution or ethical standards.

ARTICLE V: GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE & MANAGEMENT

5.1.1 Composition

The Supreme governing body of SSETI, comprising all General, Founding, and Institutional Members.

5.1.2 Powers and Functions

- Approve and amend the Constitution.
- Elect and remove members of the Board of Directors.
- Approve strategic plans, annual reports, and audited financial statements.
- Make decisions on the dissolution of the Initiative.

Section 5.2: Management & Governance Structure

The operational management structure of the South Sudan Educational Technology Initiative (SSETI) is designed to ensure strategic agility, operational efficiency, and strict accountability. This framework clearly delineates governance from day-to-day management, empowering professional leadership while maintaining robust oversight.

Section 5.3 Executive Management

At the core of daily operations is the Executive Director (ED), appointed by and reporting directly to the Board of Directors. The ED is the Chief Executive Officer of the Secretariat and

serves as the organization's legal representative in all operational, contractual, and financial matters.

Key Responsibilities of the Executive Director.

- Implement the strategic directives and policies set by the Board of Directors.
- Lead all daily operational activities, ensuring alignment with SSETI's mission, vision, and core values.
- Serve as the principal legal and public representative of SSETI.
- Prepare and present comprehensive reports on programs, finances, and strategy execution to the Board.
- Lead, manage, and develop the professional Secretariat staff.
- Convene the Annual General Assembly and Executive Committee meetings, proposing agendas and key items for governance approval.
- Oversee the engagement and management of volunteers and consultants in accordance with SSETI's Human Resource Policy.

Section 5.4 Governance Structure

Section 5.4.1 The Board of Directors

The Board of Directors (BoD) is the supreme governing body responsible for providing strategic direction, fiduciary oversight, and policy governance for SSETI. The Board shall consist of seven (7) voting members, elected from the General Assembly, and structured as follows.

- a) Chairperson
- b) Vice-Chairperson
- c) Secretary
- d) Treasurer
- e) Three (3) Additional Directors (with mandated representation for youth and women)

The Executive Director serves as an ex-officio, non-voting member of the Board.

Section 5.4.2 Terms & Elections.

Board members serve a three-year term and are eligible for re-election for one additional consecutive term. Staggered elections ensure continuity. The Board is the primary policy-making organ, charged with approving strategic plans, annual budgets, and major organizational decisions.

Section 5.4.3 Initial & Succession Planning.

Interim Board members shall be appointed by the Founding Members until the first General Assembly. In the event a senior officer (Chairperson, Secretary, Treasurer) vacates their position mid-term, the Board shall appoint an interim officer from among its members to serve until the next General Assembly ratifies a successor.

Section 5.4.3 Key Roles & Responsibilities of the Board

1. Chairperson

- a) Provides overall leadership to the Board
- b) Chairs all meetings,
- c) Acts as the primary governance spokesperson
- d) Ensures Board effectiveness and compliance.

2. Vice-Chairperson

- a) Supports the Chairperson and assumes their duties in their absence
- b) with a focus on governance process and committee oversight.

3. Secretary

- a) Ensures the integrity of governance documents
- b) records accurate minutes of all Board meetings
- c) and manages official correspondence.

4. Treasurer

- a) Oversees the financial health of SSETI
- b) Guides financial policy
- c) Reviews budgets and financial reports
- d) Ensures transparent fiscal stewardship.

Section 5.4.4 Disqualification of Board Members

A Board member shall vacate their office if they.

- a) Are declared bankrupt or insolvent.
- b) Are certified as being of unsound mind.
- c) Fail to attend three consecutive Board meetings without prior, excused absence.
- d) Submit a written resignation.
- e) Are removed by a two-thirds majority vote of the Board for gross misconduct or actions prejudicial to SSETI.

Section 5.4.5 The Secretariat (Operational Arm)

Led by the Executive Director, the Secretariat executes SSETI's programs and operations. Key professional staff positions include:

- **Program Manager (EdTech Integration).** Designs and manages core educational technology programs, teacher training, and digital lab deployments.
- **Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning (MEL) Officer:** Develops and manages the MEL framework, ensuring data-driven decision-making and impact reporting.
- **Finance & Administration Manager:** Manages all financial operations, budgeting, reporting, and administrative systems.
- **ICT & Digital Content Specialist:** Oversees technology infrastructure, digital content curation, and the development of localized Open Educational Resources (OER).
- **Partnerships & Communications Officer:** Leads resource mobilization, donor relations, strategic partnerships, and public communications.

Section 5.5 Staffing and Volunteers

5.5.1 Professional Staff Recruitment

SSETI shall recruit and employ qualified professional personnel necessary for the effective execution of its mission and strategic goals. Staffing shall be based on the operational needs outlined in the organizational structure and approved annual budgets. Recruitment will prioritize competence, integrity, and a commitment to the core values of the Initiative. Key positions shall include, but are not limited to, the Executive Director, Program Managers,

Finance and Administration Manager, Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Officer, and ICT Specialists. All employment shall be governed by a formal Human Resources Policy and compliant with the labor laws of South Sudan.

5.5.2 Volunteer Engagement

SSETI recognizes the invaluable contribution of volunteers in advancing its mission and fostering community ownership. The Initiative shall actively encourage and facilitate volunteer engagement from students, professionals, diaspora experts, and community members, particularly youth and educators. Volunteer roles shall be clearly defined, with structured onboarding, appropriate orientation, and necessary support provided to ensure a meaningful and productive experience.

5.5.3 Management and Oversight

All staff and volunteers shall operate under the direct supervision and management of the Executive Director or their designated officer. Volunteer engagements shall be formalized for specific periods, typically not exceeding six (6) months for standard assignments, with provisions for extension based on mutual agreement and program needs. The terms of engagement, including rights, responsibilities, and code of conduct, shall be detailed in the SSETI Volunteer Policy to ensure clarity, fairness, and the protection of all parties.

This structure ensures SSETI is governed with strategic foresight and managed with operational excellence, enabling the sustainable achievement of its mission to advance digital literacy and educational innovation in South Sudan.

South Sudan Education Technology Initiative

Section 5.6: Board Meetings

5.6.1 Frequency & Quorum

The Board of Directors shall convene for regular meetings at least four (4) times per year, and may schedule additional special meetings as necessary. A quorum for any Board meeting shall be a simple majority (more than 50%) of the total voting members of the Board. Decisions shall be made by a simple majority vote of members present and voting, with the Chairperson holding a casting vote to resolve any ties.

5.6.2 Calling of Meetings

(a) Regular Meetings: Regular meetings shall be convened by the Secretary, in consultation with the Chairperson. Written notice of the meeting, along with a proposed agenda and relevant

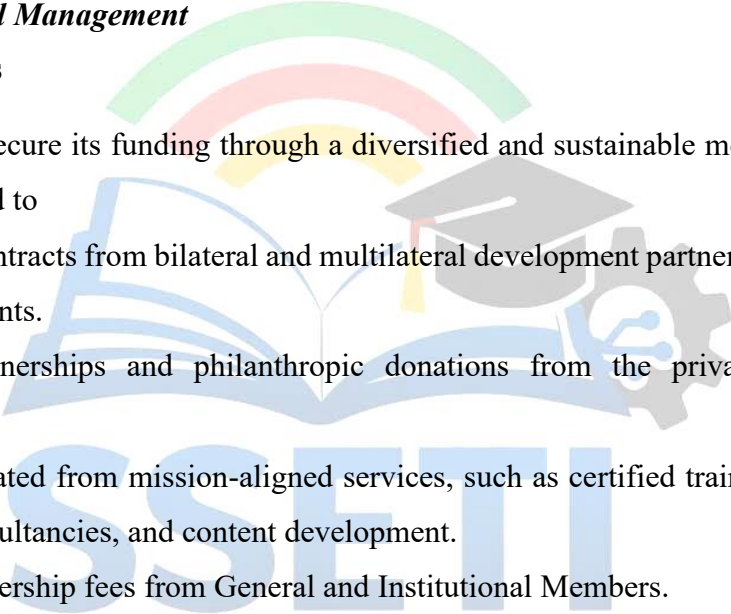
supporting documents, shall be distributed to all Board members at least fourteen (14) calendar days in advance.

(b) Special Meetings: A special meeting of the Board may be called at any time by the Chairperson or upon the written request of at least one-third ($\frac{1}{3}$) of the voting members of the Board. In such cases, the Secretary shall provide notice of the special meeting, including the specific purpose and agenda, at least seven (7) calendar days in advance, unless waived by unanimous consent of all Board members.

ARTICLE VI: FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

SSETI 6.0: Financial Management

6.1 Sources of Funds

- 
- a) SSETI shall secure its funding through a diversified and sustainable model, including but not limited to
 - b) Grants and contracts from bilateral and multilateral development partners, foundations, and governments.
 - c) Strategic partnerships and philanthropic donations from the private sector and individuals.
 - d) Income generated from mission-aligned services, such as certified training programs, technical consultancies, and content development.
 - e) Annual membership fees from General and Institutional Members.

6.1.1 Audit and Reporting

- The accounts shall be audited annually by an independent, certified auditor appointed by the General Assembly.
- The audited financial statements and annual report shall be presented to the AGA for approval and made publicly available.
- SSETI shall comply with all financial reporting requirements of the Republic of South Sudan.

6.1.2 Non-Profit Principle

No portion of the income or assets shall be distributed to members, directors, or officers except as reasonable compensation for services rendered or reimbursement for authorized expenses.

6.1.3 Financial Controls

- a) The financial year shall run from **January 1 to December 31**.
- b) All funds shall be held in SSETI's name in reputable financial institutions.
- c) All withdrawals require two authorized signatures (from among the Chairperson, Treasurer, and Executive Director).
- d) The Board shall define authorization thresholds for expenditures.

6.2 Application of Funds

All funds and assets of SSETI shall be used **exclusively** to advance the objectives stated in this Constitution. No portion of the income or assets shall be distributed to any member, director, or officer for personal benefit. Reasonable compensation may be paid for services rendered, and reimbursement may be made for necessary expenses incurred on behalf of the Initiative, in accordance with a Board-approved policy.

6.3 Financial Controls & Oversight

The Board of Directors holds ultimate fiduciary responsibility. It shall ensure robust financial controls are established and maintained, including.

- a) The maintenance of accurate, complete, and transparent accounting records.
 - b) The preparation and approval of an annual operational budget.
 - c) The authorization of all major expenditures in line with the strategic plan.
- The safeguarding of organizational assets.

6.4 Annual Financial Reporting & Audit

6.4.1 Financial Statements.

The Treasurer, in conjunction with the Secretariat's finance staff, shall ensure the preparation of annual financial statements. These statements, comprising an Income & Expenditure Account and a Balance Sheet, shall be presented to the General Assembly for formal approval.

6.4.2 Independent Audit.

SSETI's accounts shall be audited annually by an independent, certified auditor appointed by the General Assembly. The Auditor's report shall be presented alongside the financial

statements.

6.4.3 Public Disclosure.

Approved audited financial statements and the annual report shall be made publicly available to ensure transparency and accountability to all stakeholders.

6.5 Financial Year

The financial year of SSETI shall run from 1st January to 31st December of each calendar year.

SSETI 7.0: The Authority

The General Assembly (GA) is the supreme governing body of SSETI, comprising all General, Founding, and Institutional Members in good standing. It represents the collective voice of the membership.

7.2 Meetings & Quorum

7.2.1 Annual General Assembly (AGA)

The GA shall convene at least once per year, with at least thirty (30) days' written notice provided to all members.

7.2.2 Extraordinary General Assembly (EGA)

An EGA may be convened by the Board or upon a written request submitted by at least one-third of the voting members.

7.2.3 Quorum.

One-third (1/3) of all voting members shall constitute a quorum for any General Assembly meeting. Decisions shall be made by a simple majority vote of members present and voting, unless otherwise specified in this Constitution.

ARTICLE VIII: AMENDMENTS TO THE CONSTITUTION

SSETI 8.0: Amendments to the Constitution

8.1 Amendment Procedure

This Constitution may be amended by a two-thirds (2/3) majority vote of members present and voting at a duly convened General Assembly. The full text of any proposed amendment must

be circulated to all members at least thirty (30) days prior to the meeting at which it is to be considered.

ARTICLE IX: DATA MANAGEMENT AND ICT POLICY

Section 9.1: Commitment to Data Quality

SSETI is committed to collecting, managing, and using data ethically, accurately, and securely to inform decision-making and demonstrate impact.

Section 9.2: Data Governance

- The Board shall adopt a comprehensive **Data Protection and Privacy Policy**.
- A designated **Data Focal Point** (e.g., the M&E Officer) shall oversee data integrity.
- All digital content and software adopted or developed shall be subject to quality assurance for relevance, accuracy, and cultural appropriateness.

Section 9.3: ICT Infrastructure

SSETI shall invest in secure, reliable, and sustainable ICT systems to support its operations and programs, in line with a Board-approved **ICT Strategy**.

ARTICLE X: AMENDMENTS

This constitution may be amended by a **two-thirds (2/3) majority vote** of members present and voting at a duly convened General Assembly, provided that the proposed amendments are circulated to all members at least **thirty (30) days** prior to the meeting.

ARTICLE XI: DISSOLUTION

SSETI may be dissolved by a **three-quarters (3/4) majority vote** at a General Assembly specifically convened for that purpose. Upon dissolution, after settling all liabilities, any remaining assets shall be transferred to another non-profit organization in South Sudan with similar educational and technological objectives, as determined by the General Assembly.

ARTICLE X: ADOPTION AND INTERPRETATION

Section 10.1: Adoption

This Constitution was duly adopted by the Founding Members on **[Date]** and comes into force immediately.

Section 10.2: Interpretation

The Board of Directors shall have the authority to interpret the provisions of this constitution. Any dispute arising from interpretation shall be resolved through internal mediation, and if unresolved, through legal means in accordance with the laws of South Sudan.

CERTIFICATION

We, the undersigned Founding Members, hereby certify that this is the official Constitution of the South Sudan Educational Technology Initiative (SSETI).

Name: [Chairperson's Name]

Signature:

Date:

Name: [Secretary's Name]

Signature:

Date:

Name: [Treasurer's Name]

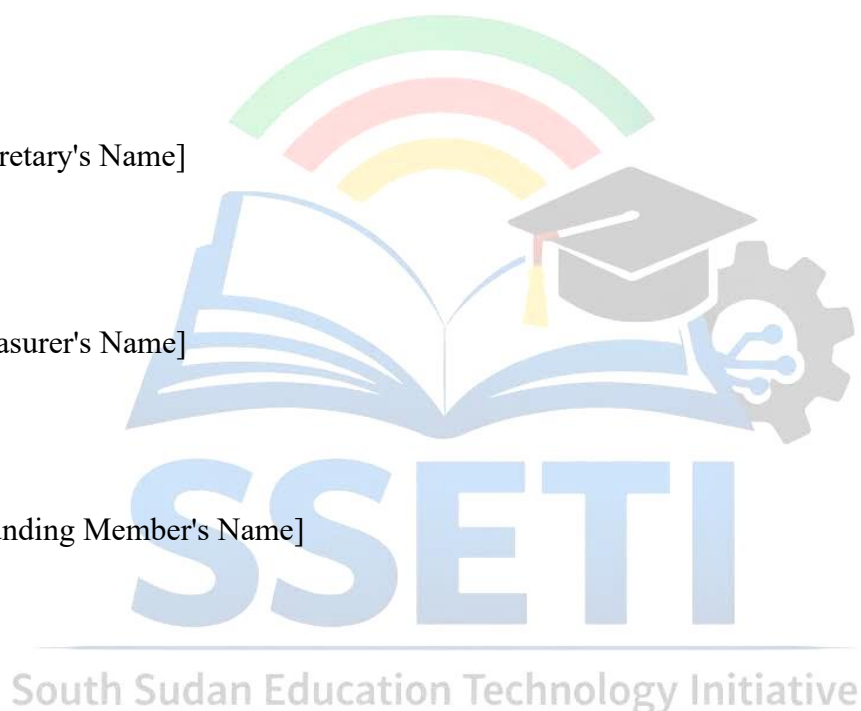
Signature:

Date:

Name: [Founding Member's Name]

Signature:

Date:



APPENDICES

Appendix A: Official Logo and Brand Guidelines

Appendix B: Detailed Financial Policy & Procedures

Appendix C: Data Protection and Privacy Policy

Appendix D: Code of Conduct and Ethics

Appendix E: Organizational Chart